to say that it must be absolute and unrestrained…."[7] There are scholars who point out to the fact that the states often agree to limit their sovereignty through the conclusion of international agreements and through their memberships of international institutions. Therefore, the principle of 'consent' becomes important as, in reality, states can and indeed bind themselves to observe certain rules and contract certain obligations.[8] There are few supporters to the idea that states, by participating in various kinds of international agreements or gaining membership to various international organizations like the United Nations or the Commonwealth of Nations, lose their status as sovereign states. There may be contentions about limited sovereignty in the present day globalized world yet it is not possible to deny that so long as the nation-state system remains the basis of the prevailing pattern of international society, the substance of sovereignty will remain even if the word "sovereignty" disappears.

The fact is that all the states on the face of this earth are considered equal and enjoy political independence. The United Nations Charter under Article II acknowledges that it "is based on the principle of sovereign equality of all its Members". This may be legally true but factually incorrect. There can be many reasons. No state is equivalent to other in terms of size, resources and economic development, and hence power. It is true that some states may be more equal than others, but reality shows that differences between states are numerous which affect their capabilities in international relations to manoeuvre and exert its power and influence on others. As Palmer and Perkins talked about the conventional classification of the states in power-political terms as "great powers" or "major powers" and "small powers" or "lesser powers," and also a category like "middle powers." Undoubtedly, there is another category of states that is weak and not so powerful in the international arena. Therefore, it is obvious that "great powers" would have leverage in bargaining and also manipulating the techniques of using rewards and punishments vis-à-vis "small powers" and weak states. Therefore, what constitutes power, obviously, brings us to the discussion about national power.